



EARLY SIGNS OF PREGNANCY

What are Early Pregnancy Signs?

Early pregnancy produces hormonal changes that trigger a variety of physical symptoms. These may appear within the first weeks after conception, often before a missed period is noticed.

Common Early Signs

- Missed period: Often the first and most recognized sign of pregnancy.
- Tender or swollen breasts: Hormonal shifts may make breasts sore or sensitive.
- Nausea or vomiting: Often called 'morning sickness,' though it can occur at any time of day.
- Fatigue: Elevated progesterone levels can cause unusual tiredness.
- Frequent urination: The kidneys process more fluid as blood volume increases.
- Light spotting (implantation bleeding): Some people notice light spotting when the embryo implants in the uterus.
- Mild cramping: Similar to period cramps, may occur during implantation.
- Mood changes: Hormonal fluctuations can affect mood and emotional well-being.
- Food aversions or cravings: Changes in taste and smell are common.
- Bloating: Progesterone may slow digestion, causing a bloated feeling.

When to Seek Medical Advice

See a healthcare provider if you experience heavy bleeding, severe abdominal pain, dizziness, or fainting, as these may indicate complications requiring evaluation.

Key Takeaway

Early pregnancy signs vary from person to person and can resemble PMS symptoms. A home pregnancy test or healthcare provider visit can confirm pregnancy.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

*Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (n.d.). Pregnancy: Frequently asked questions. Mayo Clinic. (2022).
Symptoms of pregnancy: What happens first. Office on Women's Health. (2021). Pregnancy: Body changes and discomforts.*